Department of Urban Studies and Planning,
77 Massachusetts Ave,
Massachusetts Institute of Technology,
Cambridge, MA 02139.

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mit page
scholar
imdb

DEVIN MICHELLE BUNTEN (SHE/THEY)

appointments

Associate Professor of Urban Studies and Housing, MIT, 2024–present.
Assistant Professor of Urban Economics and Housing, MIT, 2018–2024.
Edward H. (1962) and Joyce Linde Career Development Chair, MIT, 2018–Present.
Economist, Federal Reserve Board, 2016–2018.

education

Ph.D, Economics, University of California, Los Angeles, 2016.
M.A., Economics, Colorado State University, 2010.
B.A. *magna cum laude*, English/Film Studies, University of Colorado at Denver, 2005.

research areas

housing & gentrification, racial capitalism, queer & trans housing issues

research

BOOK

The Gentrification Machine: How Racial Capitalism Rebuilt America's Cities and the Middle Class. Under contract at MIT Press, forthcoming fall 2027.

JOURNAL ARTICLES

devin michelle bunten, Ellen Fu, Lyndsey Rolheiser, and Christopher Severen. "The Problem Has Existed Over Endless Years: Racialized Difference in Commuting, 1980–2019." *Journal of Urban Economics*, 141, 2024.

devin michelle bunten, Ben Preis, and Shifrah Aron-Dine. "Re-Measuring Gentrification." *Urban Studies*, 61(1):20–39, 2024.

Madeleine I.G. Daepp, devin michelle bunten, and Joanne W. Hsu. "The Effect of Racial Composition on Neighborhood Housing Prices: Evidence from Hurricane Katrina-Induced Migration'.' *Journal of Urban Economics*, 134, 2023.

devin michelle bunten and Lyndsey Rolheiser. "People or Parking?" *Habitat International*, 106, 2020.

devin michelle bunten and Matthew E. Kahn. "Optimal Real Estate Capital Durability and Localized Climate Change Disaster Risk." *Journal of Housing Economics*, 36:1–7, 2017.

devin michelle bunten, Stephan Weiler, Eric Thompson, and Sammy Zahran. ."Entrepreneurship, Information, and Growth." *Journal of Regional Science*, 55(4): 560–584, 2015.

BOOK CHAPTERS

devin michelle bunten. "Foreword." In Daniel Kay Hertz, *The Battle of Lincoln Park*. Second Edition. Belt Press, 2026.

Amy Hillier and devin michelle bunten. "A Queer and Intersectional Approach to Fair Housing." In Vincent J. Reina, Wendell E. Pritchett, and Susan M. Wachter, editors, *Perspectives on Fair Housing*, chapter 6, pages 154–185. University of Pennsylvania Press, 2020.

Leah Platt Boustan, devin michelle bunten, and Owen Hearey. "Urbanization in the United States, 1800-2000." In Louis P. Cain, Price V. Fischback, and Paul W Rhode, editors, *Oxford Handbook of American Economic History*, volume 2, chapter 22, pages 75–99. 2018.

WORKING/RESTING PAPERS

devin michelle bunten. "Re-Picturing Segregation." Manuscript, 2023.

Enjoli Hall, Malhaar Agrawal, devin michelle bunten, Connie Chao, Dayna Cunningham, Catherine D'Ignazio, Vedette Gavin, Holly Harriel, Eric Robsky Huntley, Sarah Rege, Anne Whiston Spirn, Delia Wendel, Sarah Williams, and Mariana Arcaya. "Beyond Documenting Difference." Manuscript, 2022.

devin michelle bunten. "Is the Rent Too High? Aggregate Implications of Local Land-Use Regulation." Working Paper 2017-06, Board of Governors of the Federal Reserve System, 2017.

"Measuring Gentrification in Latin America," (with Ava Hoffman and Fiorella Belli Ferro).

PUBLISHED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Sarah Williams, Malhaar Agrawal, devin michelle bunten, Connie Chao, Catherine D'Ignazio, Vedette Gavin, Enjoli Hall, Holly Harriel, Eric Robsky Huntley, Sarah Rege, Anne Whiston Spirn, and Delia Wendel. "Advancing Racial Justice Research in Architecture, Urban Planning, and Allied Fields." In *Proceedings of the Association of Collegiate Schools of Architecture*, 2022.

writing

Sex Does Not Mean Gender. Equating Them Erases Trans Lives. *The New York Times*. 2020.

Boston must bring back rent control to protect tenants. *The Boston Globe*. 2020.

Untangling the Housing Shortage and Gentrification. *CityLab*. 2019.

A Sense of Where You Are. *Frank News*. 2018.

films

The 5th of April. Associate Producer.

Love, Examined. Associate Producer.

presentations

INVITED SEMINARS

2026–2027 (scheduled): University of British Columbia (planning), UCLA (planning), Harvard (planning)
2026: University of Colorado—Denver (planning)
2024: UC Berkeley (planning)
2022: Pittsburgh/Carnegie Mellon (economics), UC Berkeley (planning), Boston University (urban studies)
2021: Boston University (urban studies)
2019: Columbia (planning), The New School (policy), NYU (policy), University of Illinois-Chicago (planning), NYU (policy)
2018: SUNY Buffalo (economics), UCLA (planning)
2017: Federal Reserve Bank of Philadelphia, MIT (planning), Colorado State University (economics)
2016: Federal Reserve Board, Bank of Canada, University of Colorado-Denver (economics), Universidad de los Andes (Bogotá; economics), Universidad del Rosario (Bogotá; economics)
2013: Colorado State University (economics)

CONFERENCES & SYMPOSIUMS

2026: Workshop on Land, Capital, and Shelter
2024: BU Critical Gentrification Studies in US Cities: A Book Symposium*
2023: BU Conference on Gentrification*
2022: BRT+ General Assembly, American Economics Association (AEA)*, Society for American City and Regional Planning History (SACRPH)*
2020: Association for Public Policy Analysis & Management (APPAM)*
2019: APPAM, SACRPH
2018: Urban Economics Association (UEA), Association of Collegiate Schools of Planning (ACSP), APPAM, Greater Boston Urban and Real Estate Economics Seminar, Conference in Urban and Regional Economics*, AEA*, World Economic History Conference*
2017: ACSP, Federal Reserve System Regional Conference
Earlier: UEA (2013, 2015), North American Regional Science Council (2010, 2012, 2014)

*—invited discussant

teaching

MIT

Housing and Racial Capitalism. 2025.
Theorizing Gentrification with Racial Capitalism. 2024.
Gentrification. 2021.
Microeconomics & Planning Economics. 2019–Present.

Housing and Social Stratification in the United States. 2018–Present.

University of California, Los Angeles
Instructor
Econ 137: Urban and Regional Economics. 2015.
Teaching Associate
Econ 1: Principles of Microeconomics. 2011–2012.
Econ 2: Principles of Macroeconomics. 2012.

Colorado State University
Teaching Assistant
Econ 101: Economics of Social Issues. 2009.
Econ 202: Principles of Microeconomics. 2008–2010.

service

editorial board

Housing Policy Debate, 2022–present.

refereeing

Urban studies and planning: Urban Studies, Journal of Planning Education and Research, Journal of Planning Literature, Journal of Race Ethnicity and the City, Housing Policy Debate, Environment and Planning A, Housing Theory and Society, Cityscape, Journal of Regional Science, Regional Studies, International Regional Science Review

Economics: Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Urban Economics, Regional Science and Urban Economics, Journal of Housing Economics, Review of Economic Dynamics, International Real Estate Review

Sociology: City & Community, Social Currents, Race and Social Problems, Social Science Research

program committee

SACRPH 2022; Boston University International Gentrification Conference 2023; Housing Policy Debate Summer Symposium 2026